

5 UNIVERSITY OF MADRAS Southern Wonder

Outstanding research work gives this varsity a slot in the top five

Two principles which have made the University of Madras an edifice of excellence are research and education for all. Overlooking the Anna Memorial and MGR Memorial on the shores of Marina beach, Chennai, the beautiful Victorian structure which houses the university was established in 1857 by the British. The university, which had only 17 departments, 30 teachers and 69 research scholars in 1912, is today a large teaching-cum-affiliating university with 18 schools and 72 departments of post-graduate teaching and research, 152 affiliated colleges and 52 approved research institutions. It also boasts of a good student-teacher ratio—there are over 400 teachers for 1,75,000 students. With over 4,000 students pursuing research programmes here, it shouldn't come as a surprise that the university has been ranked 15 among the top 35 national institutions in terms of scientific output by the ministry of science and technology. "Excellence in research and development is our strength. We emphasise on research and every teacher here has to undertake at least eight research scholars. We are likely to make significant contribution to healthcare by discovering medicines for dreaded diseases like cancer and Parkinson's at an affordable rate," says Vice-Chancellor Col. Dr G. Thiruvassagam. The university has signed MoUs with 85 foreign and 18 Indian universities, besides 21 indus-

try and service organisations. About 95 sponsored research projects, funded by various agencies, are being carried out in its various departments.

University of Madras is also a living

decades, this 152-year-old university has shown exemplary excellence in the pursuit of knowledge. The university regularly revamps its syllabi to focus on knowledge development for all, especially rural students. The university has launched a free education scheme through which 10 per cent additional seats are reserved in its various colleges for students hailing from economically poor background. The employment-oriented and skill-oriented courses run by the university

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UNIVERSITY OF MADRAS PROMOTES LEARNING AS WELL AS ONE'S INNATE TALENT

example of how an institution can work wonders, being under government control and yet breaking new grounds in research and development. Over the

focus on all-round development of the students and promises to nurture their innate talents. Its students display a rare quest for knowledge and why not? The university doesn't favour the usual textbook-oriented examination system. As its vice-chancellor explains, "Our examination system is not challenging. From this academic year, we are changing the entire system and will rather evaluate students on different parameters." This university firmly believes that learning promotes one's natural talent and going by the long list of scholars, scientists and leaders that it boasts of as its alumni, it is an undeniable truth.

by Lakshmi Subramanian



"We are very keen to promote research and development. The university has signed MoUs with 85 foreign and 18 Indian universities besides 21 industry and service organisations."

G. THIRUVASSAGAM, vice-chancellor, University of Madras